

Kayra Kalkan

Phone: (+90) 545 646 1027 | **Email:** kalkankayra@gmail.com | **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/kayra-kalkan | **Portfolio:** kayrakalkan.github.io
Address: Istanbul, Turkey | **Date of Birth:** 27/07/2004 | **Nationality:** Turkish

ABOUT ME

Fourth year Statistics student at Marmara University with hands on experience in data science, machine learning, and AI driven solutions. Completed an Erasmus+ exchange in Budapest, where I built production ready AI applications, developed end to end ML pipelines, and created full stack web solutions. Experienced in processing large scale datasets, NLP, and automation. I thrive in multicultural environments through international collaborations and voluntary projects.

EDUCATION

Marmara University | Bachelor of Statistics | Sep 2022 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey
Key Courses: Artificial Intelligence, Data Science, Machine Learning with Python, R Programming, Statistical Modeling
Erasmus+ Exchange Program | Sep 2025 – Apr 2026 | Budapest, Hungary

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI DEVELOPER INTERN – SOFTTECH | Jun 2026 – Jul 2026 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Built an item based recommendation model that suggests books by category, using each user's ratings and reading history
- Built the web app around it, with a React frontend and a REST API backend connected to a database
- Planning to extend the recommendation system with a RAG based feature for more personalized suggestions

AI DEVELOPER – MARUNGPT PROJECT | Jan 2024 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey

- Developed AI powered chatbot serving hundreds of students using Python, NLP, and Elasticsearch for semantic search
- Integrated OpenAI API generating contextually accurate responses, improving information access by 60%
- Built production ready system managing information retrieval workflows and handling real user traffic

DATA SCIENTIST INTERN – COCRM | Sep 2024 – Nov 2024 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Conducted data mining on 25,000+ company records using Python, Pandas, and NumPy to extract business intelligence
- Built automated web scraping pipeline with proxy rotation and request throttling for reliable large scale data collection
- Generated performance metrics reports and actionable insights for stakeholders

VR GAME DEVELOPER – METARIOM SOFT | May 2024 – Nov 2024 | Istanbul, Turkey (Hybrid)

- Developed immersive VR experiences using Unreal Engine for international game development company
- Collaborated with multicultural team across different time zones, demonstrating strong remote work and self management skills

KEY PROJECTS

Tennis Match Prediction ML System | Aug 2025

- Built end to end ML pipeline achieving 72.9% accuracy using XGBoost and feature engineering (Elo ratings, surface stats)
- Technologies: Python, Pandas, Scikit learn, XGBoost

AI Based Fine Tuning Song Lyrics Translation | Apr 2024

- Fine tuned language models for contextually accurate song lyrics translation preserving emotional meaning and cultural nuances
- Created training datasets from human translated lyrics pairs and built search interface for AI generated translations
- Technologies: Python, Machine Learning, NLP, Model Fine tuning

AI Based Flights & Vacation Tracker | 2025

- Built MCP server AI agent automating optimal meeting point discovery for travelers from different cities
- Scrapes flight platforms to find cost effective common destinations and generates personalized vacation itineraries
- Technologies: Python, Playwright, OpenAI API, MCP Server, Pandas, SQLite

LANGUAGES

Turkish: Native | **English:** B2 (Upper Intermediate) – ITEP certified – ESC project interviews passed, daily communication in English with international teams

VOLUNTEERING

ESC Volunteer – BAGázs | Sep 2025 – Apr 2026 | Budapest, Hungary
European Solidarity Corps program developing cross cultural communication and collaboration skills in multicultural settings
ESN Marmara Volunteer | 2024 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey
Organizing events for exchange students, coordinating logistics, and mentoring incoming international students